

Hunting by night

All owls eat small animals. They swoop silently on their victims in the dark and grab them in their sharp talons.

In the dark owls sometimes find animals only by the sounds they make.

Tawny owl



Most owl chicks learn to fly when they are two months old. Until then, they are fed by their parents.

Owls like to eat animals, such as mice and small birds.



An owl's mouth may look quite small but it can open very wide indeed.

Eating

Owls cannot chew so they swallow their food whole. When they have digested the animal, they cough up the bones and fur as a small pellet.

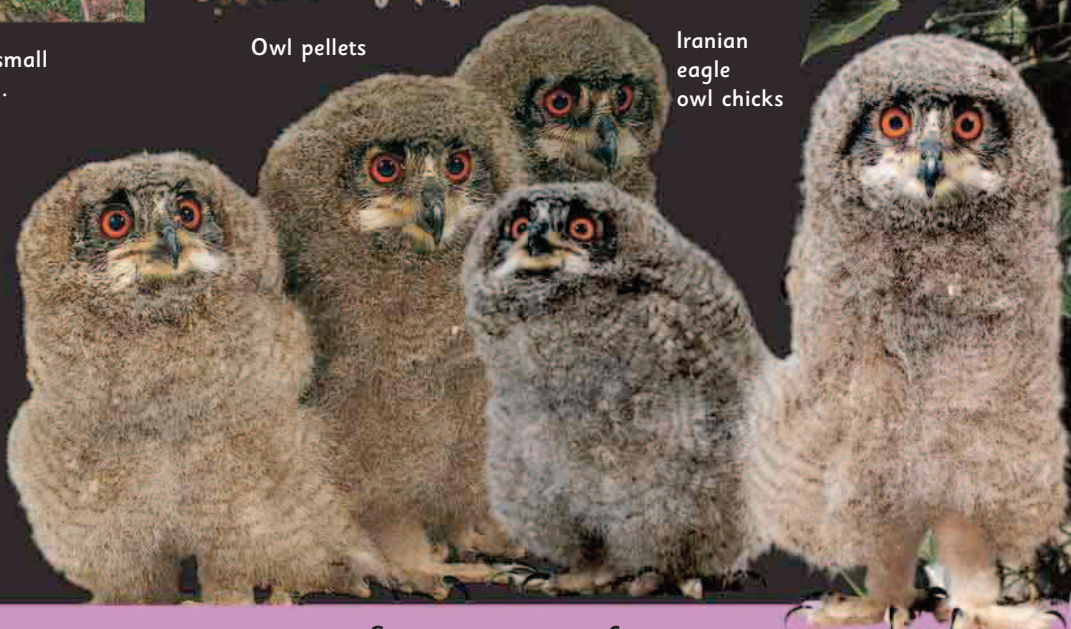


Owl pellets

If you tear one of these pellets apart, you can see the whole skeleton of the animal it has just eaten.

Owl chicks

Rather than build nests, owls prefer to lay their eggs in holes of some kind – in trees or buildings. The male and female both help to feed the chicks.



Iranian eagle owl chicks

The elf owl – it is only 15 cm (6 in) tall.